

# THE BLACK PANTHER

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## Schoolchildren Spark Black Revolt

# SOUTH AFRICA EXPLODES



Young Black South African protestors display their militancy in Soweto "township" of Johannesburg while school bus burns. Although originally a protest over educational policy, a widespread revolt against apartheid has developed.

(Soweto, South Africa) - Sparked by a student protest over a needless compulsory language requirement imposed by the White minority government, smoldering resentment over this country's policy of strict racial segregation known as apartheid exploded into sustained rage last week as Blacks throughout South Africa rose up in open rebellion.

Unofficial reports on Monday, June 21, placed the death toll at close to 200, with some 1,500 wounded, as South African military police opened fire with "shoot-to-kill" orders on the Black demonstrators, many of whom, in the initial incidents, were school children. "It's no good firing over their heads," a White senior police official said in justification of the mounting casualties.

Angry, roving crowds of Blacks in at least nine "townships" surrounding Johannesburg, and in another three "townships" outside Pretoria burned buses, beerhalls, police stations, dilapidated Bantu school buildings and other administrative structures to display their disgust over their abysmal living conditions and lack of control over any meaningful aspect of their lives.

This rage was expressed to one French reporter who managed to slip past a police roadblock and meet with some Black protesters. One man told the reporter, "We are going to burn all the beerhalls and administrative buildings." Pointing to a burning football stadium, the man said, "We don't want beerhalls and football. We want schools and education."

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